

1.2 Planning and conducting research	Learners should be familiar with the following features of planning and conducting research and their associated strengths and weaknesses:
Aims and hypotheses and how to formulate	• research aim • research question • null hypotheses • alternative hypotheses • one-tailed (directional) hypotheses • two-tailed (non-directional) hypotheses.
Populations, samples and sampling techniques	• target population and sample • random sampling • snowball sampling • opportunity sampling • self-selected sampling.
Experimental designs	• repeated measures design • independent measures design • matched participants design.
Variables and how they are operationalised	• independent variable (IV) • dependent variable (DV) • control of extraneous variables.
Designing observations	• behavioural categories • coding frames • time sampling • event sampling.
Designing self-reports	• open questions • closed questions • rating scales: ○ Likert rating scale, Semantic differential rating scale.

